

ASUS Zenbook S14 OLED

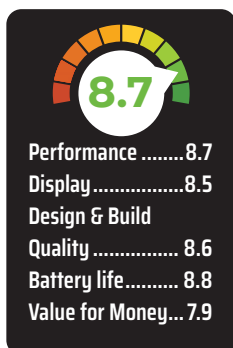
Intel strikes back!

₹1,49,990



The ASUS Zenbook S 14 is the first laptop based on the latest Intel Lunar Lake platform, running on the Intel Core Ultra 7 258V SoC. We reviewed the ASUS Zenbook S16 last month, which was based on the latest AMD Ryzen AI 300 platform. At that time, we compared the AMD Ryzen AI 300-based laptop to the last-gen Intel Meteor Lake platform and the Qualcomm Snapdragon X-Elite platform. With Intel's latest offering on our test bench, we now have the opportunity to see how the Intel Lunar Lake platform stacks up against Qualcomm and AMD.

The Intel Core Ultra 7 258V chip in the ASUS Zenbook S 14 is not the top-of-the-line variant in the Core Ultra 200 series: it's a mid-tier option. Meanwhile, the other laptops being compared in our review of the ASUS Zenbook S 14 run on top-tier variants, if not the absolute highest. This is an important aspect of this review and shapes how we interpret the comparison—the numbers here don't reflect the maximum possible performance one can expect from Intel Lunar Lake-based laptops. During the



Intel Lunar Lake performance and benchmarking sessions, we attended earlier this month, Intel claimed to have the fastest single-core performance and integrated graphics performance on Windows. We've seen Intel achieve class-leading single-core performance on Windows before; however, the claim of graphics performance supremacy was certainly a direct challenge to AMD's Ryzen AI 300 series. In our last iGPU tests across Intel, AMD, and Qualcomm, AMD managed to edge out the competition.

ASUS made it clear that the Zenbook S 14 is not aimed at casual gaming but is focused on being a premium thin-and-light offering that emphasizes performance and efficiency. However, given that Intel's significant advancements with Lunar Lake revolve around iGPU and AI performance, we were keen to test the iGPU's prowess—and what better way than gaming benchmarks? Besides graphics performance, another major highlight with Lunar Lake is efficiency; Intel is confident that Lunar Lake laptops can deliver 20+ hours of battery life in real-world scenarios. Let's

take a look at how the ASUS Zenbook S 14, equipped with the latest Intel Core Ultra (Series 2) processor and the new Intel Arc 140V integrated GPU based on Intel's Xe2 architecture, performs against its competition. We ran a suite of CPU, GPU, and AI performance benchmarks to assess the capabilities of the ASUS Zenbook S 14.

CPU PERFORMANCE

With fewer cores and no multithreading support, multicore performance is not the strong suit of the Intel Lunar Lake chip. However, it compensates with very strong single-core performance. Interestingly, the performance remained consistent whether the laptop was on battery or plugged into a power source. This consistency was observed across all benchmarks, including gaming tests. The multicore performance gap is a point of concern, given that the Intel Lunar Lake laptop performs lower than the previous-generation Meteor Lake laptop.

Clearly, when it comes to CPU performance, Intel has prioritized efficiency and power management over raw multicore performance. And we understand why. With Lunar Lake, Intel aims to prove that you can achieve class-leading battery life on x86-based laptops.

GPU PERFORMANCE

Here's where things get particularly interesting. The ASUS Zenbook S 14 topped the charts in synthetic GPU benchmarks, and by a comfortable margin. The Intel Arc 140V is undeniably a fast and capable integrated GPU, redefining expectations for a 28W chip. The performance numbers were identical when tested on battery power. In some cases, we were pleasantly surprised to see the on-battery performance slightly surpassing that when plugged in.

In gaming tests, the narrative remains consistent. The ASUS Zenbook S 14, while not designed or marketed for gaming, is one of the fastest laptops we've tested in terms of iGPU performance. Achieving this at a 28W TDP is very impressive.